Ismail Khan

Cloud Architect

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Professional Summary

Azure Cloud Architect with **17** years of **IT Experience** and a **decade** of **Architecture** experience. Expertise in leading **enterprise-wide Cloud Adoption initiatives**. Expertise in **modernizing legacy workloads** and infrastructure using Cloud Services, backed by strong experience in **Windows Server Administration**, Active Directory, DNS, and enterprise infrastructure management. Expertise in **designing** and **implementing scalable, secure, cost-efficient cloud native and hybrid solutions** for enterprise applications leveraging **IaaS, PaaS** and **SaaS** services. Expertise in **DevOps** practices developing **CI/CD strategies, IaC, FinOps, and Automations**. Strong **Leadership** and **communication skills** consistently delivering a **CSAT score of 5**. A **quick learner** and **adaptable problem solver**, I excel at **Optimizing Cloud Infrastructures, and delivering organizational Blue Chips**. Skilled at bridging the gap between **technical teams** and **business stakeholders** by **articulating complex cloud solutions** in a **clear, non-technical manner** tailored for **executive audiences**. Passionate about **innovation** and **continuous improvement**.

Certifications:

- Microsoft Certified: Azure Solutions Architect Expert (AZ-305)
- Microsoft Certified: Azure Security Engineer Associate (AZ-500)
- Microsoft Certified: Azure Administrator Associate (AZ-104)
- Microsoft Certified: Azure Fundamentals (AZ-900)
- Microsoft Certified: Power Platform Developer Associate (PL-400)
- Microsoft Certified: Power Platform Functional Consultant Associate (PL-200)
- Microsoft Dynamics 365 for Customer Service (MB-230)
- Microsoft System Center Configuration manager 2007, configuring (70-401)
- Oracle Cloud Infrastructure 2025 Foundations Associate - 1Z0-1085-25
- Oracle Cloud Infrastructure 2025 AI Foundations Associate - 1Z0-1122-25
- Oracle Cloud Infrastructure 2025 Migration Architect Professional – 1Z0-1123-25
- Windows 7, Enterprise Desktop Administrator (70-686)
- Microsoft Copilot Partner Bootcamp – FY24 Participant
- Hashi Corp Certified: Terraform Associate (003)
- ITIL V3 Foundation
- Splunk User Certification
- Big Data and Hadoop (Edureka)

Key Skills

- **Cloud Technologies:** Microsoft Azure, Oracle Cloud, AWS
- **Operating Systems:** Win7, Win10, Linux, Ubuntu, CentOS, Red Hat, Suse
- **Server Administration:** Windows Server (2008, 2012, 2016, 2019, 2022), Active Directory, DNS, DHCP, GPO, SCCM, Patch Management, Backup & Recovery, Azure Update Management
- **Programming/Scripting Languages:** C, C++, C#, Java, Python, Batch, VBScript, PowerShell, Bash, Shell
- **Automation Tools:** Terraform, ARM Templates, Selenium
- **Frameworks:** .Net, React
- **Networking Protocols:** DNS, DHCP, WAN, TCP/IP, UDP, ICMP, NFS, SMTP, LAN, FTP
- **Web development:** HTML, CSS, JavaScript, Typescript
- **Virtualization technologies:** Windows Hyper-V, VirtualBox, VMWare Workstation

- **Containerization and Orchestration:** Docker, Kubernetes, AKS
- **Database:** SQL Server, Oracle, MySQL
- **Logging & Monitoring Tools:** Splunk, Azure Monitor, Log Analytics Workspace, New Relic
- **Version Control Tools:** Git, GitHub, BitBucket
- **Build Tools:** Windows Installer, MSI, PowerShell App Deployment Toolkit
- **Continuous Integration:** Jenkins, Terraform Enterprise
- **ITSM Tools:** AHA, Rally, ServiceNOW
- **IDE:** Visual Studio, PoweShell IDE, VSCode, Notepad++
- **AI:** Azure AI Studio, GitHub Co-Pilot, Copilot for Security
- **Languages:** Fluent in spoken and written English, Hindi Urdu

Education

Bachelor Of Engineering - Computer Science

Visvesvaraya Technological University, Bengaluru Karnataka, India (06/2004 – 05/2008)

Experience

Cloud Engineer | Gibraltar Technologies | June 2025 – Present | Dubai, United Arab Emirates

- Delegated to du as a Cloud Engineer.
- Design Enterprise grade Azure Landing Zone for Dubai's largest Public Sector / Government – Transportation & Infrastructure entity.
- Working closely with key stakeholders for discovery and preparing the HLD, LLD documentation.
- Designed and delivered an enterprise-grade Azure Landing Zone for Dubai's largest Public Sector / Government – Transport & Infrastructure entity, establishing a secure, scalable, and DESC-compliant cloud foundation.
- Defined the Azure Cloud Migration Strategy, creating standardized migration templates to streamline workload onboarding.
- Implemented governance, identity, and policy frameworks aligned with UAE Smart Government directives. While maintaining a DESC compliant Landing Zone.

Architect | Optum Global Solutions | December 2020 – June 2025 | Bengaluru Karnataka, India

- Developed a one-stop solution/framework for all Cloud and DevOps initiatives.
- Collaborated closely with the pre-sales team to respond to RFPs and RFIs by designing high-level cloud architectures, estimating costs, and presenting tailored Azure solutions that aligned with client requirements and business goals.
- Designed and implemented robust Identity and Access Management (IAM) strategies using Microsoft Entra, including role-based access control (RBAC), conditional access policies, identity governance, and secure hybrid identity integrations to ensure least-privilege access and regulatory compliance across Azure environments.
- Applied Microsoft's Cloud Adoption Framework (CAF) to guide enterprise customers through structured cloud adoption, including strategy, governance, readiness, implementation phases, ensuring alignment with business and compliance requirements across hybrid and multi-cloud landscapes.
- Applied the Azure Well-Architected Framework (WAF) to review and optimize cloud solutions across five key pillars—cost optimization, operational excellence, performance efficiency, reliability, and security—ensuring scalable, resilient, and high-performing architectures aligned with best practices.
- Conducted comprehensive assessments of customers' existing cloud environments, evaluating architecture, security posture, cost efficiency, and operational readiness to identify gaps and provide actionable recommendations for optimization and future scalability.

- Successfully migrated complex SAP and non-SAP workloads to Azure, ensuring minimal downtime, enhanced performance, and cost optimization.
- Architected modern cloud-native and hybrid solutions tailored to diverse enterprise application workloads. Designed scalable architectures using Azure IaaS, PaaS, microservices, containers, and serverless computing to meet business and performance goals while ensuring compliance and security
- Modernized legacy workloads and infrastructure using Azure services, driving operational efficiency, resilience, and alignment with cloud best practices.
- Built and matured DevOps practices using Terraform Enterprise, Jenkins, Azure DevOps and GitHub Actions, enabling continuous integration and continuous delivery (CI/CD). Automated infrastructure provisioning (IaC) with Terraform and Bicep, reducing deployment times, human error, and operational overhead. Established guardrails and workflows that support secure, compliant automation at scale.
- Spearheaded infrastructure automation using Terraform and Bicep, reducing provisioning time and manual errors. Developed more than 100 reusable Terraform modules.
- Collaborated with Application, Security, and Infrastructure teams to align technical solutions with business outcomes.
- Managed a team of Enterprise Architects who provide consultancy services for customers.
- Managed multi-tenant cloud environments, ensuring seamless onboarding, governance, high security across accounts onto Cloud Service Provider (CSP) program.
- Onboarded GovCloud customers, ensuring compliance with industry standards and regulatory requirements like HIPAA, GDPR, PCI-DSS and NIST.
- Designed Cloud Security Posture Management (CSPM) framework using Defender for Cloud and Prisma Cloud.
- Designed monitoring solutions with Azure Monitor, Log Analytics, and custom alerts. Developed Splunk Queries, Reports, Dashboards, and Alerts for proactive cloud resource monitoring.
- Created comprehensive technical documentation for onboarding processes, cloud architectures, deployment processes, and security policies. Prepared executive-level reports on cloud performance and costs.
- Designed and deployed custom golden images for VMs for consistent deployments.
- Led security audits, identifying gaps and applying remediation strategies to enhance security posture.
- Configured multi-environment support in Terraform Enterprise for compliance across dev, staging, and production environments.
- Implemented branching strategy in Version Control System for Application resources.
- Automated testing processes using HP Quality Center, maintaining high-quality standards.
- Provided technical guidance and mentorship to engineering and operations teams. Also assisted with troubleshooting issues.
- Lead disaster recovery (DR) and business continuity planning (BCP) for cloud workloads.

Supervising Associate | EY | September 2019 – December 2020 | Bengaluru Karnataka, India

- Designed, developed, and implemented microservices architectures using Azure Kubernetes Service (AKS) for scalability, flexibility, and high availability.
- Proficient with containerization, and microservices design, along with hands-on expertise in Azure Cloud services and Kubernetes.
- Utilized Docker for containerization, AKS for orchestration.
- Utilized Azure Disk Storage for Persisting application data.
- Exposed application using Istio Ingress Gateway.
- Implemented Scaling using KEDA.

- Implemented and maintained CI/CD pipelines for automated deployment, integration, and testing.
- Implemented robust monitoring, logging, and alerting solutions using Azure Monitor, Azure Log Analytics and Prometheus/Grafana stack.
- Ensured the security and compliance of AKS environments by implementing role-based access control (RBAC), network policies, and secure secrets management using Azure Key Vault.

Cloud Ops Engineering Specialist | Accenture | April 2013 – September 2019 | Bengaluru Karnataka, India

- Led assessment and discovery phase by conducting infrastructure and application inventory, identifying interdependencies, and evaluating cloud readiness.
- Defined migration strategy aligned with business objectives, selecting appropriate migration approaches (7 R's) for each workload.
- Designed and implemented Azure landing zones with enterprise-grade security, networking, identity, and compliance configurations.
- Built isolated test environment in Azure for mock testing, ensuring production-like accuracy and pre-deployment readiness.
- Collaborated with architects, infrastructure teams, and application owners to define the target cloud architecture and migration plan.
- Set up governance, RBAC, policies, and cost controls in Azure to support secure and scalable operations (FinOps practices).
- Managed environment provisioning including compute, network, storage, database, security, monitoring and alerting tools.
- Executed migration of workloads (including SAP and non-SAP systems) using tools such as Azure Migrate, ASR, and Database Migration Services.
- Coordinated pre- and post-migration testing activities to validate performance, integration, and security.
- Implemented automation for infrastructure provisioning and configuration using Terraform and Bicep.
- Established CI/CD pipelines and DevOps practices for continuous deployment and environment consistency.
- Monitored migrated workloads using Azure Monitor and Log Analytics, implementing alerts and dashboards for operational visibility.
- Drove post-migration optimization, including cost analysis, right-sizing of resources, and performance tuning.
- Implemented Azure Site Recovery (ASR) and Backup for SAP BCDR strategies.
- Facilitated knowledge transfer, documentation, and transition to operations teams for ongoing support.
- Managed Windows Server environments (2008–2022), performing installation, configuration, patching, backup, and security hardening, ensuring 99.9% uptime and compliance with organizational standards.
- Acted as a liaison between technical teams and business stakeholders, ensuring alignment, issue resolution, and timely delivery.
- Maintained project oversight, risk management, and status reporting across stakeholders and leadership teams.

ITO Service Delivery Consultant | Hewlett Packard | July 2010 – April 2013 | Stockholm, Sweden

- Collaborated with clients and application owners to streamline application packaging, deployment, testing, and UAT processes, ensuring smooth implementation and end-user readiness.
- Participated in stakeholder calls, Change Advisory Board (CAB) approvals, and incident management, while performing pre-evaluation assessments, integration testing, and production deployments.
- Managing enterprise Servers including and not limited to deploying, hardening, patching, configuring and decommissioning servers.

SuperValu Services India | System Engineer| September 2008 – July 2010 | Bengaluru Karnataka, India

- Led end-to-end IT infrastructure and application packaging operations, managing large teams and ensuring seamless deployments through SCCM and Intune.
- Streamlined Windows 10 migration, process optimization, and compliance reporting while enhancing delivery efficiency and stakeholder satisfaction.

Automation and Special Projects

- NCAP - Customer Onboarding Automation: Developed a React-based frontend web application hosted on GitHub with a custom domain, backed by RESTful APIs leveraging Azure Serverless Computing resources. This solution fully automated the customer onboarding process, reducing the onboarding timeline from 4-5 weeks to just 1 week.
- Secrets Management with Azure Key Vault: Implemented a zero-touch, fully automated process for managing enterprise secrets with proper monitoring and alerting mechanisms.
- Prisma Cloud (CSPM Solution): Developed and implemented Prisma Cloud standards, incorporating relevant policies for cloud security posture management (CSPM). Integrated policy violations with Sentinel and ITSM tools.
- Automated Deployment of Sentinel Cisco Connectors Runbooks: Developed Infrastructure as Code (IaC) for pipeline deployment of Cisco Connectors Runbooks, ensuring seamless ingestion of data into Sentinel for monitoring and analysis.
- Service Automation Initiatives: Led several service automation projects, including:
  - Application Packaging Dashboard in SPLUNK: Developed a dashboard for automating the packaging and deployment of applications (ClickOnce, WebApp, and FastTrack).
  - Partially Automated Source Review and QA Process: Streamlined the review and QA process through automation.
  - Application Decommissioning and Deployment: Automated the decommissioning of applications and their subsequent packaging and deployment.
  - Pending SSL Certificates Automation: Automated the management of pending SSL certificates to ensure timely renewal and deployment.
  - UDS File Share Creation and Service Account Management: Automated file share creation and management of service accounts.
  - GPO Creation: Automated the creation of Group Policy Objects (GPOs) for efficient policy management.
  - App Deployment Incident Automation: Automated incident handling related to application deployments.
  - SCCM Client Health Remediation: Implemented automation to address SCCM client health issues and generate health reports.